CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Print on Demand Course Handbook

"Sell custom-designed products worldwide, with zero inventory."

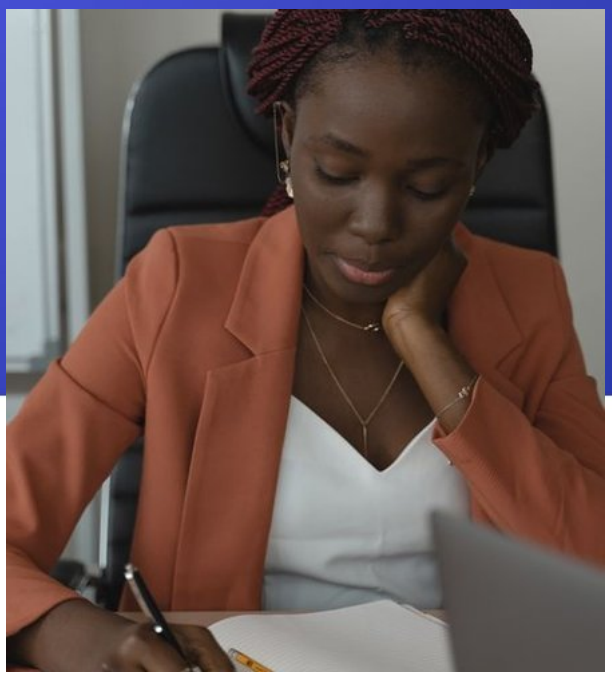


Design & Digital Commerce Track | 8 Weeks | Beginner

Self-Paced Study Edition

Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame | chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com

Course Foreword



Print on demand (POD) lets you sell t-shirts, mugs, posters and more without buying stock, printing anything, or shipping a single parcel. A platform prints and ships each item only after a customer orders. You supply the design and the marketing; they handle the rest.

This is one of the few online businesses where a beginner with a laptop and taste can compete globally. It is not free money, designs and marketing decide success, but the risk is tiny because you never pay for stock that might not sell.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will choose a niche, create designs that sell, set up a store, write listings that get found, and market your way to passive product income without ever holding stock.

Treat it as a design-and-marketing business. The people who win create many designs, study what sells, and keep improving. Start simple, publish, and learn from real sales.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 8-module workbook equips youth and emerging leaders with practical, ethical, income-ready skills. Complete every chapter drill in a dedicated workbook and reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Outcomes

01

Introduction to print on demand: No stock, no shipping, the platform fulfils orders.

02

Design basics for POD: Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.

03

Creating listings that sell: Listings are your marketing, write for search.

04

Scaling your income: Launch with a solid batch, then keep adding.

Across 8 Weeks of structured practice, learners progress from core principles to real-world execution. Every module pairs concise frameworks with an immediate hands-on drill so knowledge turns into demonstrable competence.

Graduates finish with a tangible portfolio deliverable in Print on Demand, ready to serve clients, employers, ministries, and communities with excellence and integrity.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 1: Introduction to print on demand | Module 2: Choosing your niche



1.1 Introduction to print on demand

In POD, you upload a design, place it on products in an online catalogue, and list them for sale. When someone buys, the platform prints your design on the item and ships it directly to the customer. You keep the difference between the base cost and your selling price. No upfront stock, no storage, no shipping headaches.

The trade-off for this low risk is lower profit per item and heavy competition, so volume and good marketing matter. Some platforms (like Redbubble) also bring their own shoppers, which is perfect for beginners; others require you to drive all the traffic yourself. Understanding this model clearly is the first step to using it well.

Real-World Example: A designer uploads one funny slogan design and places it on shirts, mugs and stickers. Over months, with no stock and no shipping on her side, those listings quietly sell to buyers around the world while she creates more.

Hands-On Practice: Browse a POD marketplace like Redbubble. Find three best-selling designs and note what they have in common (style, humour, niche, simplicity).

Core Takeaways: No stock, no shipping, the platform fulfils orders. • Low risk, but lower margins and high competition. • Marketplace platforms bring built-in shoppers.

1.2 Choosing your niche

Generic designs get lost; niche designs get bought. A niche is a specific group with a shared identity or interest, nurses, cat lovers, gym-goers, a hobby, a profession, a hometown pride. People love wearing what says 'this is me,' and they search for exactly that. A tight niche makes both your designs and your marketing far easier.

Pick niches with passion and spending power, and ideally ones you understand, so your designs feel authentic rather than generic. You can serve several small niches over time. Avoid trademarked names, logos and slogans, using protected brands will get your account banned, so create original work around themes, not brands.

01

Practitioner Case

'Funny t-shirt' is hopeless in search. 'Sarcastic nurse t-shirt' finds a passionate, specific buyer who feels seen, and happily pays. The narrower the identity, the easier the sale.

02

Action Drill

List five niches you understand or belong to. For each, write one design idea that people in that group would proudly wear.

03

Key Standard

Specific niches sell; generic designs get lost. People buy designs that say 'this is me'. Never use trademarked brands, originals only.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 3: Design basics for POD | Module 4: Setting up on Redbubble

2.1 Design basics for POD

You do not need to be a trained artist. Many top-selling POD designs are simple: a clever phrase in a nice font, clean typography, or a minimal graphic. Free and low-cost tools like Canva let anyone create sellable designs. What matters is a clear idea, readable text, and a look that suits the niche and product.

Learn the technical basics: designs need to be high resolution, usually with a transparent background, and sized correctly for the product. A great idea ruined by a blurry or badly-placed image will not sell. Keep designs clean and legible even as a small thumbnail, because that is how buyers first see them.

Core Principle

Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.

Field Case Study

One of the best-selling POD styles is just bold text: a relatable phrase in a strong font on a plain background. No drawing skill needed, just wit, clean typography and the right niche.

Applied Exercise

Create three simple text-based designs in Canva for your chosen niche. Export them high-resolution with a transparent background.

Mastery Check

Use free tools like Canva. • High resolution and correct sizing are essential.

2.2 Three-Step Execution Rhythm

Step 1

Prepare & Frame
Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.

Practice Focus
Audit your current approach before acting.

Step 2

Execute Deliberately
Use free tools like Canva.

Practice Focus
Focus on clarity, calm pace, and measurable value.

Step 3

Review & Refine
High resolution and correct sizing are essential.

Practice Focus
Record outcomes and sharpen one habit per rep.

2.3 Setting up on Redbubble

Redbubble is beginner-friendly because it hosts your products, prints, ships and even brings shoppers through its own marketplace search. You create a free account, set up your shop, and upload designs, placing each on the products you choose. This is the fastest way to get your first sales without needing your own website or traffic.

Fill your profile and shop properly, a clear name, banner and bio build trust. Enable the products that suit each design (a wordy joke works on shirts and mugs; a detailed graphic suits posters). Set your profit margin sensibly: too high and nothing sells, too low and it is not worth it. You can adjust as you learn.

01

Redbubble prints, ships and brings shoppers.

02

A complete profile builds buyer trust.

03

Match each design to suitable products; set margins wisely.

2.4 Real-World Case & Lab Assignment

Practitioner Case Study

A learner set up a Redbubble shop in an afternoon, uploaded ten designs across shirts and stickers, and made her first international sale within weeks, purely from Redbubble's own search traffic, with no outside marketing.

Your Practical Assignment

Create a Redbubble account, complete your shop profile, and upload your three designs onto suitable products with a sensible margin.

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Study Principle: "Redbubble prints, ships and brings shoppers. Consistent execution in small daily assignments builds authority that cannot be faked."



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 5: Creating listings that sell | Module 6: Marketing your store

3.1 Creating listings that sell

On marketplaces, most sales come from search, so your listing text is your marketing. Use clear, keyword-rich titles and tags that describe exactly what the design is and who it is for ('funny nurse mug gift for night shift'). Think like the buyer: what words would they type? Fill every tag with relevant terms, this is how the platform matches you to shoppers.

Good visuals close the sale. Use the platform's mockups so buyers see the design on a real-looking product, and make sure it looks great as a small thumbnail. A strong title, complete tags and clean mockups turn a hidden design into a findable, buyable product.



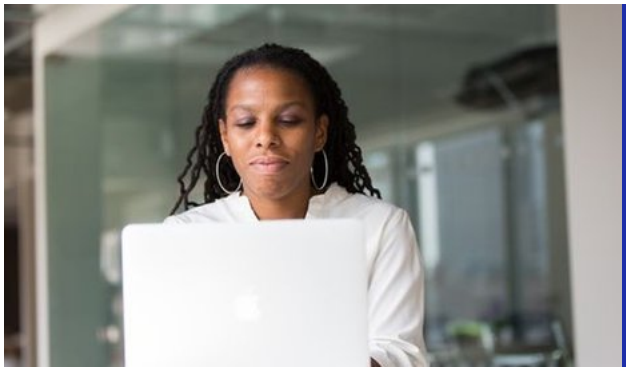
Case: Two identical designs, different listings. The one with a vague title 'Cool Design 1' never sold; the one titled and tagged 'Funny Teacher Appreciation Gift T-Shirt' started selling, because buyers could finally find it.

Action Drill: Write a keyword-rich title and a full set of tags for each of your designs, imagining the exact words your buyer would search.

3.2 Marketing your store

Marketplace search alone can bring sales, but marketing multiplies them. Share your designs on social media where your niche gathers, a nurses' design in nursing groups, a gym design on fitness pages. Content showing the products in real life (photos, short videos) drives clicks. You become your own free advertising channel.

Building a small audience around your niche pays long-term: an Instagram or TikTok page for your design theme brings repeat buyers and lets you launch new designs to warm fans. Marketing is also feedback, watch which designs people react to and make more like them. Selling and listening go together.



Case: A creator posted her hiking-themed designs in outdoor Facebook groups and on a small Instagram page. Those free posts, not the marketplace search, became her biggest source of sales, and her followers requested new designs she then made and sold.

Action Drill: Share one of your designs in a relevant online community or on a niche social page. Note any clicks, feedback or sales it brings.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 7: Scaling your income | Module 8: Launch your POD store

4.1 Scaling your income

POD is a numbers game: more good designs across more products and niches means more chances to be found and bought. Once you know what sells, batch-create designs in your winning styles and niches. Many part-time POD sellers grow simply by consistently uploading, keeping the winners, and dropping the duds.

Scale smart, not just big. Double down on your best-performing niches and design styles rather than spreading thin. Consider expanding to other platforms (some let you sell on your own store or via Etsy) once you have proven designs. Reinvest a little time or money into better design tools as your income grows.

Field Example: A seller noticed that of her 50 designs, five made most of the sales, all in one niche and style. She made twenty more like those five, and her income climbed, because she followed the data instead of her guesses. | Drill: Once you have some sales, identify your best niche/style. Create five new designs in that exact lane and publish them.

4.2 Launch your POD store (Capstone)

Your final project is a live store with a real set of designs, enough to look established and give the platform's search something to work with. Do not wait for perfect designs; publish a solid batch, then keep adding. A live store that exists and sells beats a perfect one still in your imagination.

Then run the loop that builds real income: create, list well, market a little, watch the data, and make more of what works. POD rewards patience and consistency over months, not days. Keep uploading, keep learning from sales, and the passive income slowly compounds as your catalogue grows.

Competency Area	Capstone Standard	Starting	Target Mastery
1. Clarity & Preparation	More quality designs = more chances to sell.	Needs Draft	Confident & Ready
2. Execution Quality	Launch with a solid batch, then keep adding.	In Practice	Portfolio-Grade
3. Real-World Proof	Launch your store with at least ten designs across suitable products. Commit to adding a few new designs each week for the next month.	Planned	Completed & Reviewed
4. Consistency Habit	POD rewards patience and a growing catalogue.	Occasional	Weekly Discipline

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice Matrix

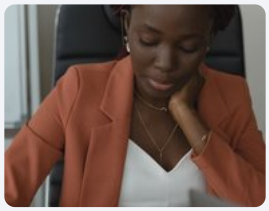
Use this checklist to track every hands-on assignment in Print on Demand from Module 1 to your final project:

Module	Focus Topic	Core Deliverable & Principle
Module 01	Introduction to print on demand	No stock, no shipping, the platform fulfils orders.
Module 02	Choosing your niche	Specific niches sell; generic designs get lost.
Module 03	Design basics for POD	Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.
Module 04	Setting up on Redbubble	Redbubble prints, ships and brings shoppers.
Module 05	Creating listings that sell	Listings are your marketing, write for search.
Module 06	Marketing your store	Marketing multiplies marketplace sales.
Module 07	Scaling your income	More quality designs = more chances to sell.
Module 08	Launch your POD store	Launch with a solid batch, then keep adding.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Reflections

"A designer uploads one funny slogan design and places it on shirts, mugs and stickers. Over months, with no stock and no shipping on her side, those listings quietly sell to buyers around the world while she creates more."
CHRISCO Youth Aflame Cohort Case Note | Module 01





"A learner launched with fifteen designs and committed to adding five a week. Sales were quiet for a month, then steadily grew as her catalogue and best-sellers built up, the classic POD curve for those who don't quit early."
CHRISCO Digital Academy Capstone Highlight | Module 08

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Print on Demand is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 drills and document your baseline specimen in Print on Demand.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Launch your store with at least ten designs across suitable products. Commit to adding a few new designs each week for the next month.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

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Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO Digital Academy
Under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Official Gmail Contacts
chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
shambetz@gmail.com

Official Course E-Book for Print on Demand (Design & Digital Commerce Track).
Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES.
For course guidance or mentorship, email chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.

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